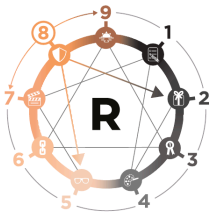
TYPE

8

THE CHALLENGER

The Protector



The Powerful Presence Who Transforms the Business

CORE MOTIVATION IN THE SALON

> Type Eights are driven by a need for control, strength, and autonomy. They do not like to feel manipulated or constrained, and they move through the world with confidence and directness. In the salon, Eights are natural leaders — they own their talent, advocate fiercely for their clients, and often build empires.

CLIENT COMMUNICATION STYLE

- Eights communicate directly, confidently, and without a lot of softening. They say what they see.
- Clients who want honesty — 'Tell me what will actually look good' — love an Eight. Clients who want to be coddled may feel slightly steamrolled.
- **Natural strength:** Clients feel they are getting the truth. No flattery, no games — just expertise and directness.
- **Growth edge:** Softening delivery without compromising honesty. Not every client needs the full Eight — learn to calibrate.

THE CONSULTATION

- Eights take charge in consultations — they ask clear questions, offer confident recommendations, and set the direction.
- They can move too fast or steamroll a client who is uncertain or needs more time to process.
- **Tip:** Build in a genuine question that gives the client control: 'What's the one thing you absolutely love about your hair right now?'

CREATIVITY & ARTISTRY

- Eights approach creativity with boldness — they are not afraid to try something dramatic or push for something more impactful.
- They do their best work when they have creative freedom and a client who trusts them.
- Their creative confidence is compelling — clients often let Eights do what they think is best because the Eight's conviction is powerful.

SELF-WORTH MASTERY: MOVING FROM FIXED TO GROWTH

- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'Showing uncertainty or asking for help makes me look weak.' → Identify one area of your business or craft where you would genuinely benefit from input. Ask one trusted person for

their perspective this week — not because you need it, but as a practice of strength. Notice that receiving doesn't diminish you.

- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'I lead with force because it works — but sometimes people seem to pull away.' → Think of one person in your team or clientele who you sense has pulled

back. What would a version of you that leads with warmth AND strength say to that person? Write it, then say it.

- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'I resist systems and structures that feel like someone else controlling me.' → What is one structure — a booking policy, a cancellation fee, a team protocol — that you've been resisting that would actually give you more freedom, not less? Implement it this month. Notice what freedom feels like on the other side.
- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'I built this on my force of will, and I'm not sure it can survive without me carrying it.' → Name one person in your world who could take on more responsibility if you trusted them with it. What is the first thing you could hand to them this week? Building others is not weakness — it is the definition of lasting power.
- **Your growth affirmation:** True strength includes the courage to be known, to ask, and to care openly. I am powerful and tender. I build legacies, not just careers.

BUILDING YOUR BUSINESS BEHIND THE CHAIR

- Eights are among the most naturally gifted business builders in the Enneagram — decisive, strategic, willing to take risks, and capable of building something from nothing.
- Own your authority. Set your prices high, enforce your policies, and operate from a place of genuine confidence in your value. Clients who respect quality will meet you there.
- Build a team. Eights are natural leaders and genuinely thrive when they can leverage others' strengths. The Eight behind the chair forever is not maximizing their potential — the Eight who builds a team and a culture is.
- Develop and protect your reputation. Eights often build their brand on word-of-mouth authority — the stylist everyone hears about, who doesn't need to advertise because their reputation precedes them. Invest in this deliberately.
- **Create non-negotiable standards for your business:** policies around late arrivals, cancellations, deposits, and client conduct. Eights enforce these without apology — and clients with integrity respect them.
- **Watch for:** Building a business that depends entirely on your personal force of will. Systematize, delegate, and develop team members so the business grows beyond what one person can sustain.

SELLING SERVICES & RETAIL

- Eights are natural closers — direct, confident, and unapologetic. 'This is what you need. Here's why.'
- They don't like waffling or soft-selling — they make clear recommendations and mean them.
- **Best approach:** Frame retail as an extension of their expertise and care. Eights protect their clients — and recommending the right product is protection.
- Eights who buy into a product will sell it relentlessly and authentically. Don't ask them to sell something they don't believe in.
- Eights make decisive, confident retail recommendations that clients follow without question.
- **They can turn retail into advocacy:** 'I would never let you leave without this. Your hair needs it.'
- **Watch for:** Being so direct that it comes across as pressure rather than care. Some clients need the recommendation wrapped in warmth, not just authority.

FEEDBACK, BOUNDARIES & TOUGH CONVERSATIONS WITH CLIENTS

- Eights receive feedback best when it comes from someone they genuinely respect — and when it is delivered directly and without softening around the edges. They have no patience for passive- aggressive communication or hint-dropping.
- They can become defensive when they feel their authority is being undermined. Separate the feedback from the power dynamic: 'I respect your skill — here's what I'm observing.'
- **With unhappy clients:** Eights instinctively want to take control and resolve the situation decisively. This is largely effective — but watch for dismissing the client's emotional experience in the rush to fix the technical one.
- **Setting limits with clients:** Eights are the best at enforcing limits. They state their policies without apology and without excessive explanation. This is a genuine strength — model it for your team.
- **Giving feedback:** Eights can be brutally direct in ways that bruise rather than build. Pair directness with genuine belief in the person: 'You are capable of more than this — here's specifically what I'd push on.'
- **Tough conversations:** Eights rarely avoid necessary confrontation — but they can escalate when a lower-temperature approach would have been more effective. Practice: match the intensity of the conversation to the situation, not to your emotional state.

TEAM DYNAMICS, FEEDBACK & UTILIZING YOUR GIFTS ON A SALON TEAM

- On a salon team, Eights are the force multiplier. When an Eight is aligned, the whole team moves with greater intention, confidence, and momentum.
- They are natural protectors — they will defend their team members, their clients, and their values with genuine fierceness. The team that earns an Eight's loyalty gets an extraordinary advocate.
- **Natural team contribution:** Leadership, decisive action, business development, client advocacy, and the bold energy that moves a team from good to exceptional.
- **Growth edge:** Developing patience with team members who move more slowly or need more support. An Eight who leads only through force leaves no room for others to grow — and eventually stands alone.
- **Watch for:** Eights can inadvertently create fear-based team dynamics. High standards communicated harshly produce compliance without creativity. Lead with genuine care alongside your directness.
- **Power move:** Mentor a team member who is struggling — and do it with softness. Nothing builds an Eight's legacy faster than demonstrating that their strength includes the capacity to lift others up.
- Eights thrive in salon cultures that reward competence and directness. They chafe in environments with passive leadership, unclear expectations, or unaddressed underperformance.

CAREER PATH ALIGNMENT

- Salon Owner / Entrepreneur — control, vision, autonomy — everything an Eight needs to thrive
- Business Coach or Salon Consultant — helping other owners build stronger businesses
- Platform Artist / Brand Director — leading creative vision with authority and presence
- Session Stylist for High-Profile Clients — working with clients who want a strong, confident creative partner

STRESS & GROWTH PATHS

UNDER STRESS

Under stress (moving toward Type 5), Eights withdraw, become secretive, and isolate — strategizing alone and making unilateral decisions that miss important context.

IN GROWTH

In growth (moving toward Type 2), Eights open their hearts — discovering that genuine care is not weakness but their greatest source of power. They become extraordinary mentors who inspire fierce loyalty.

WINGS

Every type is influenced by one of its neighboring types — called a wing. While your core type remains primary, your wing adds flavor and nuance to how you show up in the salon.

8w7 — The Maverick

The 7 wing adds excitement, spontaneity, and expansive energy. These stylists are bold AND fun — high-energy forces of nature who are thrilling to be around and exceptionally entrepreneurial.

- **Client Style:** Bold, fun, electric. Clients feel like they are on the best kind of ride.
- **Selling Style:** Enthusiastic AND authoritative. Clients feel it would be foolish not to take the recommendation.
- **Challenge:** Can overwhelm quieter clients. Needs to develop awareness of when to pull back the volume.

8w9 — The Bear

The 9 wing softens the Eight's intensity with groundedness and patience. These stylists are powerful but calm — a steady, authoritative presence that clients find deeply reassuring.

- **Client Style:** Calm confidence. Clients feel safe in the hands of someone who is clearly in command but not aggressive.
- **Selling Style:** Grounded, clear, authoritative. Doesn't need to push — the conviction speaks for itself.
- **Challenge:** Can procrastinate on difficult decisions or avoid conflict that needs to be addressed.

YOUR GENIUS: A COSMETOLOGIST SUMMARY

GENIUS INSIGHT

Type Eights bring something the cosmetology profession is hungry for: genuine leadership. In an industry where so many gifted practitioners remain perpetually behind the chair — never building, never scaling, never stepping into the full power of what they could create — the Eight's drive, decisiveness, and willingness to take risks are extraordinary gifts. Their growth invitation is integration: to bring the warmth and care they feel on the inside to the surface. When an Eight stops performing strength and starts embodying it — when they lead not just through force but through genuine love for the people in their care — they become the kind of leader others build careers around. The Eight who is both powerful and tender is not just a great stylist. They are a standard-bearer, a culture-shaper, and a force for genuine transformation in the industry.